

Inside Voices: Messages that Move Teams

SELN Annual Meeting 2025

Objective:

Identify communication strategies to develop and sustain thriving and functioning internal teams

But first.....

Communication strategies that can unintentionally keep teams from moving forward or being effective.



Lack of or incomplete communication or information

- No clear vision or objectives communicated
- Things go unsaid or assumed
- The wrong people are at the table for key conversations
- No action items, timelines or follow-up are identified during conversations
- Take time to agree on rules of engagement

Lack of transparency

- Rules of engagement are developed within a team, but side or backroom conversations continue to happen outside of the team
- When key info is held back, this can lead to lack of trust or lack of engagement

Communication only consists of top-down edicts

- Communication only happens one way, as opposed to multi-directional
- No meaningful opportunity for input, feedback or additional context/conversation

Unclear objectives

- No clear workplan(s) that identifies:
 - Priority areas
 - Roles and responsibilities
 - Timeframes
 - Resources
 - Problem solving when things go wrong
- No regular time to review status of workplans